

PRACTICAL COURSE WORKBOOK

Build a Digital Business from Scratch

Develop a service or business process you can explain clearly

LEVEL	Beginner
GUIDED TIME	5 hours across 12 lessons
PROJECT	a client-ready brief, plan and evidence pack
SKILLS	Business, Freelancing, SaaS, Revenue, Critical evaluation, Documentation
EDITION	Structured draft - version 0.9

WHAT YOU WILL BE ABLE TO DO

- Use Business appropriately in a realistic, bounded task.
- Use Freelancing appropriately in a realistic, bounded task.
- Use SaaS appropriately in a realistic, bounded task.
- Use Revenue appropriately in a realistic, bounded task.

WHO THIS IS FOR

People developing evidence-based digital products and services.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

- A problem area or customer group to investigate

Use this workbook with the online lessons. It is designed for A4 printing, handwritten evidence notes, and offline revision. It does not provide certification.

WORKBOOK GUIDE

A clear route through the course

Build a Digital Business from Scratch is a structured, practical course covering Business, Freelancing, SaaS, Revenue. It emphasizes explainable methods, checked work and a final outcome that can be reviewed.

MODULE	LESSONS AND FOCUS
01 Business: Customer evidence	1. Problem discovery with Business 2. Research with Freelancing 3. Positioning with SaaS
02 Freelancing: Offer design	1. Scope with Revenue 2. Value with Business 3. Pricing with Freelancing
03 SaaS: Delivery	1. Operations with SaaS 2. Quality with Revenue 3. Finance with Business
04 Revenue: Sustainable growth	1. Measurement with Freelancing 2. Retention with SaaS 3. Risk with Revenue

HOW TO USE EACH LESSON PAGE

- 1 Read the objective and identify the decision it supports.
- 2 Attempt the retrieval prompt before checking the online explanation.
- 3 Reproduce the worked example with the stated input.
- 4 Test one normal case and one boundary or failure case.
- 5 Record the result, limitation and next action in the evidence log.

PRINT AND FILE

Print at 100% scale on A4 paper. Use double-sided printing with long-edge binding. Keep completed pages with the project files named in the evidence log.

MODULE 01

Business: Customer evidence

Apply Business through problem discovery, research, positioning.

LESSON 01 / 18 MIN

Problem discovery with Business

Learning objectives

- Explain problem discovery in the context of Build a Digital Business from Scratch.
- Apply Business to a bounded practical task.
- Evaluate the result using explicit quality criteria.

Key terms

problem discovery, Business, business

Retrieval prompt

In Build a Digital Business from Scratch, which evidence best supports a problem discovery result produced with Business?

Evidence to keep

☐ Original input ☐ Observed result ☐ Boundary or failure result ☐ Limitation and next action

LESSON 02 / 22 MIN

Research with Freelancing

Learning objectives

- Explain research in the context of Build a Digital Business from Scratch.
- Apply Freelancing to a bounded practical task.
- Evaluate the result using explicit quality criteria.

Key terms

research, Freelancing, business

Retrieval prompt

In Build a Digital Business from Scratch, which evidence best supports a research result produced with Freelancing?

Evidence to keep

☐ Original input ☐ Observed result ☐ Boundary or failure result ☐ Limitation and next action

LESSON 03 / 26 MIN

Positioning with SaaS

Learning objectives

- Explain positioning in the context of Build a Digital Business from Scratch.
- Apply SaaS to a bounded practical task.
- Evaluate the result using explicit quality criteria.

Key terms

positioning, SaaS, business

Retrieval prompt

In Build a Digital Business from Scratch, which evidence best supports a positioning result produced with SaaS?

Evidence to keep

[] Original input [] Observed result [] Boundary or failure result [] Limitation and next action

MODULE REVIEW

Turn the module into usable evidence

1. RETRIEVE

Without checking the lessons, explain the module's three most important ideas in your own words.

2. APPLY

Describe the example or file you produced, the input used, and the result you observed.

3. REVIEW

Record one uncertainty, one source to recheck, and the next deliberate practice action.

MODULE 02

Freelancing: Offer design

Apply Freelancing through scope, value, pricing.

LESSON 04 / 30 MIN

Scope with Revenue

Learning objectives

- Explain scope in the context of Build a Digital Business from Scratch.
- Apply Revenue to a bounded practical task.
- Evaluate the result using explicit quality criteria.

Key terms

scope, Revenue, business

Retrieval prompt

In Build a Digital Business from Scratch, which evidence best supports a scope result produced with Revenue?

Evidence to keep

☐ Original input ☐ Observed result ☐ Boundary or failure result ☐ Limitation and next action

LESSON 05 / 18 MIN

Value with Business

Learning objectives

- Explain value in the context of Build a Digital Business from Scratch.
- Apply Business to a bounded practical task.
- Evaluate the result using explicit quality criteria.

Key terms

value, Business, business

Retrieval prompt

In Build a Digital Business from Scratch, which evidence best supports a value result produced with Business?

Evidence to keep

☐ Original input ☐ Observed result ☐ Boundary or failure result ☐ Limitation and next action

LESSON 06 / 22 MIN

Pricing with Freelancing

Learning objectives

- Explain pricing in the context of Build a Digital Business from Scratch.
- Apply Freelancing to a bounded practical task.
- Evaluate the result using explicit quality criteria.

Key terms

pricing, Freelancing, business

Retrieval prompt

In Build a Digital Business from Scratch, which evidence best supports a pricing result produced with Freelancing?

Evidence to keep

[] Original input [] Observed result [] Boundary or failure result [] Limitation and next action

MODULE REVIEW

Turn the module into usable evidence

1. RETRIEVE

Without checking the lessons, explain the module's three most important ideas in your own words.

2. APPLY

Describe the example or file you produced, the input used, and the result you observed.

3. REVIEW

Record one uncertainty, one source to recheck, and the next deliberate practice action.

MODULE 03

SaaS: Delivery

Apply SaaS through operations, quality, finance.

LESSON 07 / 26 MIN

Operations with SaaS

Learning objectives

- Explain operations in the context of Build a Digital Business from Scratch.
- Apply SaaS to a bounded practical task.
- Evaluate the result using explicit quality criteria.

Key terms

operations, SaaS, business

Retrieval prompt

In Build a Digital Business from Scratch, which evidence best supports a operations result produced with SaaS?

Evidence to keep

☐ Original input ☐ Observed result ☐ Boundary or failure result ☐ Limitation and next action

LESSON 08 / 30 MIN

Quality with Revenue

Learning objectives

- Explain quality in the context of Build a Digital Business from Scratch.
- Apply Revenue to a bounded practical task.
- Evaluate the result using explicit quality criteria.

Key terms

quality, Revenue, business

Retrieval prompt

In Build a Digital Business from Scratch, which evidence best supports a quality result produced with Revenue?

Evidence to keep

☐ Original input ☐ Observed result ☐ Boundary or failure result ☐ Limitation and next action

LESSON 09 / 18 MIN

Finance with Business

Learning objectives

- Explain finance in the context of Build a Digital Business from Scratch.
- Apply Business to a bounded practical task.
- Evaluate the result using explicit quality criteria.

Key terms

finance, Business, business

Retrieval prompt

In Build a Digital Business from Scratch, which evidence best supports a finance result produced with Business?

Evidence to keep

[] Original input [] Observed result [] Boundary or failure result [] Limitation and next action

MODULE REVIEW

Turn the module into usable evidence

1. RETRIEVE

Without checking the lessons, explain the module's three most important ideas in your own words.

2. APPLY

Describe the example or file you produced, the input used, and the result you observed.

3. REVIEW

Record one uncertainty, one source to recheck, and the next deliberate practice action.

MODULE 04

Revenue: Sustainable growth

Apply Revenue through measurement, retention, risk.

LESSON 10 / 22 MIN

Measurement with Freelancing

Learning objectives

- Explain measurement in the context of Build a Digital Business from Scratch.
- Apply Freelancing to a bounded practical task.
- Evaluate the result using explicit quality criteria.

Key terms

measurement, Freelancing, business

Retrieval prompt

In Build a Digital Business from Scratch, which evidence best supports a measurement result produced with Freelancing?

Evidence to keep

☐ Original input ☐ Observed result ☐ Boundary or failure result ☐ Limitation and next action

LESSON 11 / 26 MIN

Retention with SaaS

Learning objectives

- Explain retention in the context of Build a Digital Business from Scratch.
- Apply SaaS to a bounded practical task.
- Evaluate the result using explicit quality criteria.

Key terms

retention, SaaS, business

Retrieval prompt

In Build a Digital Business from Scratch, which evidence best supports a retention result produced with SaaS?

Evidence to keep

☐ Original input ☐ Observed result ☐ Boundary or failure result ☐ Limitation and next action

LESSON 12 / 30 MIN

Risk with Revenue

Learning objectives

- Explain risk in the context of Build a Digital Business from Scratch.
- Apply Revenue to a bounded practical task.
- Evaluate the result using explicit quality criteria.

Key terms

risk, Revenue, business

Retrieval prompt

In Build a Digital Business from Scratch, which evidence best supports a risk result produced with Revenue?

Evidence to keep

[] Original input [] Observed result [] Boundary or failure result [] Limitation and next action

MODULE REVIEW

Turn the module into usable evidence

1. RETRIEVE

Without checking the lessons, explain the module's three most important ideas in your own words.

2. APPLY

Describe the example or file you produced, the input used, and the result you observed.

3. REVIEW

Record one uncertainty, one source to recheck, and the next deliberate practice action.

CAPSTONE PROJECT

Produce a reviewable Build a Digital Business from Scratch project using Business, Freelancing, SaaS.

DELIVERABLE	A working Build a Digital Business from Scratch artefact plus an evidence-based self-review.
TOOLS	A suitable Business environment, A plain-text decision log, Test data or realistic sample material

Production plan

- 1 Define the intended user, outcome and constraints.
- 2 Create the smallest complete result using Business.
- 3 Test one normal case, one boundary case and one failure response.
- 4 Revise the work from the evidence and preserve before-and-after results.
- 5 Prepare a concise handover containing method, limitations and next step.

Definition of done

- The output matches the stated outcome.
- Inputs and decisions are reproducible.
- Boundary and failure evidence is included.
- Limitations and responsibility considerations are explicit.

PROJECT EVIDENCE

Document decisions another person can review

1. PURPOSE AND USER

State the intended user, need, expected outcome and constraints.

2. INPUTS AND ASSUMPTIONS

List source files, data, versions, permissions and assumptions.

PROJECT EVIDENCE

Tests, limitations and revision

3. NORMAL CASE

Expected result, observed result and evidence location.

4. BOUNDARY OR FAILURE CASE

What was difficult, what happened and why it matters.

5. REVISION AND LIMITATION

What changed, what improved and what remains unproven.

REVIEW AND SOURCES

Make the work credible and repeatable

Final self-review

- Can another learner repeat the method?
- Did I test a difficult case?
- Did I avoid unsupported claims?
- Is the next action proportionate to the remaining risk?

FINAL DECISION

Is the project ready to share? State the evidence, remaining risk, owner and next review date.

Authoritative references

Business Guide

U.S. Small Business Administration - reviewed 2026-08-21

<https://www.sba.gov/business-guide>

SME and Entrepreneurship Policy

OECD - reviewed 2026-08-21

<https://www.oecd.org/en/topics/sub-issues/sme-and-entrepreneurship-policy.html>

SOURCE NOTE

Product versions, laws and professional standards can change. Recheck the linked primary source before applying version-sensitive information.

NEXT IMPROVEMENT

Choose one weakness found during review and improve it before extending the Business scope.